Chief Financial Officer

JOBS TO BE DONE

PROFESSIONAL

- **Deliver predictable, profitable growth:** I need to grow revenue and margins in a way that's predictable, sustainable, and shows up reliably in our financial results.
- **Control financial risk and downside exposure:** I need to minimize financial and regulatory risk so there are no surprises that could impact earnings, cash flow, or credibility.
- **Maintain visibility and control:** I need clear, reliable visibility into what's driving performance so I can explain results with confidence.
- **Support innovations:** I want to enable the company to move quickly, innovate, and support new growth initiatives, while maintaining financial discipline.
- **AI Adoption & Digital Transformation**: I need to support outcome-driven AI that improves financial performance and operational efficiencies.

PERSONAL

- **Reputation and Credibility:** I want the board and CEO to trust me to protect margins and the brand.
- **Peace of Mind:** I want peace of mind knowing we're not one bad season, fraud spike, or peak-period failure away from a margin miss.
- **Strategic Leader:** I want to be seen as a growth enabler, not just a cost cutter. I want to support the CEO's vision by giving the business the confidence to scale responsibly.

VALUE

One Sentence Pitch

Companies, like Nike, ASOS, eBay, and Nordstrom, use Forter's AI fraud and payment solutions to increase gross margin expansion by maximizing transaction success while eliminating the costs of fraud and policy abuse.

HIGH PRESSURE INDICATORS

What to look for in an opportunity that may indicate an urgency to change?

FINANCIALS

- Public reports with initiatives highlighting:
  - EBITDA
  - Rule of 40
  - Margin improvement
  - Free Cash Flow

TECH / TIMING

- Looking to support agentic commerce flows
- Expanding to a new region or vertical
- Planning a platform migration (e.g., Shopify/Salesforce): If a merchant is already planning platform migrations, creating ideal implementation timing without additional disruption.

OPERATIONS

- Increasing headcount of manual reviews or customer service agents to support post-holiday returns, item-not-received claims, or chargebacks.

IMPACT: WHY ACT NOW?

The Case for Immediate Action

AGENTIC COMMERCE	With the rise of agentic shopping, CFOs need to understand the implications on company strategy to guide investments accordingly.
AI RISK AND OPPORTUNITY	AI is introducing new risks to the business that may impact margins, such as more sophisticated returns abuse or item-not received. At the same time, it's introducing new opportunities to increase efficiency and decrease manual costs.
RISING COST OF SALE	Global margins are under pressure as finance teams face tariffs, rising payment fees, and the growing cost of fraud/abuse and card monitoring programs.
SECURE GROWTH INITIATIVES	Support new growth initiatives, such as entering a new region or undergoing a digital transformation, without introducing new risks that hurt the initiatives profitability.